

10 April 20

The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse

I Word Meanings:-

1. Hallmark: a distinct feature or symbol of quality

2. Magnificence: splendor

3. Mysterious: difficult to understand

4. Crazy: wild, foolish, etc.

5. Tapping: striking lightly or repeatedly

6. Stuck: unable to move

II Relevance of the Title:-

The title is quite appropriate. It is through the beautiful white horse we learn the main characters of the story. All get related to the horse, in one way or the other.

Aram and Murad ride, its owner John Byro sees his own horse but refuses to recognise it because, it would mean blaming the boys. Even uncle Khosrove had some amusing remark about the horse.

Key Points:-

* Murad and Aram were two poor armenian boys aged 13 and 9 years respectively, both belonged to poor stricken, honest Gargghenian tribe. Both had intense longing for horse ride, going against the family reputation.

* Murad was considered a crazy person, the descendent of his crazy uncle, A big powerful man who was very impatient.

* One day both the boys came face to face with the horse's owner John Byro, while they were taking the horse to its hiding place.

* John Byro examined the horse and studied it tooth by tooth though he mentioned that the horse looked identical to his stolen horse but never suspected the boys as their family was well known for their honesty.

* The boys returned the horse in better health and better temper to John Byro.

* John Byro visited Aram's parents to tell off a great miracle that his horse 'The disappeared horse' returned mysteriously.

III Multiple Choice Questions:-

Q1 What is the significance of John Byro's trust in the Garaghamian family?

- (i) It shows his ignorance
- (ii) It reflects the strong moral reputation of the family. (✓)
- (iii) It proves he is careless
- (iv) It indicates he is afraid of them.

Q2 Why does Aram initially decide to join Murad despite suspecting the truth?

- (i) He is forged by Murad
- (ii) He wants to prove Murad wrong
- (iii) He is tempted by the thrill of riding. (✓)
- (iv) He plans to tell the owner

Q3 Why does Murad insist that they are not stealing the horse?

- (i) Because they intend to return it.
- (ii) Because the horse was wandering freely
- (iii) Because they consider it an act of stealing. (✓)
- (iv) Because the owner is rich.

IV Answer the following Short Questions:-

Q1 Why did Aram find it hard to believe that Murad had stolen the horse?

Ans Aram found it hard to believe Murad had stolen the horse because their tribe, the Garaghamians, was known for strict honesty. Murad's love for horses seemed natural, not criminal, so theft felt

inconsistent with their family's reputation and values.

Q2 How does the story deal with moral duty and temptation?

Ans The story highlights moral duty versus temptation through Murad's act of taking the horse. Though tempted by his passion, he struggled with the tribe's tradition of honesty. Aram too feels torn - enjoying the ride yet knowing its wrong - showing the conflict between desire and ethical responsibility.

Q3 How did Uncle Khusrav react to John Byro's complaint about the stealing of his horse?

Ans Uncle Khusrav reacted with his usual fiery temper and indifference when John Byro complained about his stolen horse. Khusrav shouted, "It's no harm. Pay no attention to it!" He dismissed the matter abruptly, showing his habit of silencing problems with his loud, careless attitude.

V Answer the following Long Questions:-

Q1 What distinction does the narrator make between 'stealing a horse for a ride' and 'stealing money'?

Ans Aram distinguishes between stealing for pleasure and stealing for gain. He feels that taking a horse for a ride is not truly theft, as it brings joy without intent to sell or profit. In contrast, stealing money directly harms others and

violates the Garoghlanian tribe's tradition of honesty. Murad's act is seen as a boyish temptation, driven by passion for horses, while stealing money would be a deliberate, immoral act. This distinction reflects the tribe's values - where integrity is paramount, and even minor lapses are judged against their reputation for honesty. Thus, the story explored how innocence and temptation can blur moral boundaries, yet true theft remained unacceptable.

Theme:-

The story brings out quick contrast between the values of the old world and those of the new world. Values like simplicity and honesty are highly cherished by the tribe, they steal the horse as they refuse to believe its a theft.

The writer of point at that the new generation might move away from the age of values in the community is the times of to come.

II

Long Question:-

Q1